

French A1 — Week 4 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner French | Week 4

Theme: Reflexive Verbs and Daily Routine

What You Will Learn This Week

Week 4 introduces reflexive verbs — the verbs French uses for the actions you do to yourself: getting up, showering, getting dressed, going to bed. You have already seen two of these as phrases: *Je me lève* and *Je me couche*. This week you will learn how they work and add several more.

You will also start reading and using clock times in French, so your routine narration can include the actual hours.

What You Will Be Able to Say by the End of Week 4

By the end of Session 8, you should be able to narrate a complete daily routine:

Je me réveille à six heures et demie. Je me lève à sept heures. Je me douche, puis je m'habille. Je me prépare en vingt minutes. Je travaille de neuf heures à dix-sept heures. Le soir, je mange avec ma famille. Je me couche vers vingt-deux heures.

And describe someone else's routine:

Mon mari se lève vers sept heures et demie. Il se prépare rapidement — il ne se douche pas le matin, il préfère le soir. Il commence à travailler à neuf heures. Il se couche toujours avant onze heures.

How Reflexive Verbs Work

A reflexive verb is just a regular verb with an extra pronoun in front — one that says the action comes back to you:

Subject	Reflexive pronoun	Example
je	me (m' before vowel)	je me lève / je m'appelle
tu	te (t' before vowel)	tu te lèves / tu t'appelles
il / elle	se (s' before vowel)	il se lève / elle s'appelle
nous	nous	nous nous levons
vous	vous	vous vous levez
ils / elles	se (s')	ils se lèvent

The verb itself conjugates normally. The only new part is the pronoun. *Je me lève* — *lever* is conjugated as *lève* (like any regular -er verb with an accent change); *me* is the reflexive pronoun that goes before it.

*Before a vowel or silent *h*, *me* becomes *m'*.*

- *Je m'appelle* — not *je me appelle*

- *Je m'habille* — not *je me habille*
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One Thing That Surprises Students This Week

In English, "I get up" and "I get myself up" mean the same thing. English usually drops the "myself." French always keeps it — *je me lève* (literally: I myself get up). This feels redundant at first. After you say it a few hundred times, it is just part of the rhythm.

The other surprise: *nous nous* (we get ourselves...) looks strange. *Nous nous levons* — two *nous* in a row. Both are doing different jobs: the first is the subject, the second is the reflexive pronoun. You will get used to it.

What to Practice Between Sessions

After Session 7 — before Session 8:

1. **Say your morning routine.** From waking up to leaving the house — 4 sentences using reflexive verbs. Out loud, twice.
2. **Write it down.** 4 sentences with correct reflexive pronouns. Check that *me* becomes *m'* before vowels.
3. **Practice the *il/elle* forms.** Take your morning routine and say it about someone else: *il se réveille à..., il se douche...*

After Session 8 — before Session 9:

1. **Write your complete routine.** 5–7 sentences from morning to evening. Mix reflexive verbs and regular -er verbs. Include specific clock times where you know them.
 2. **Say it without notes.** Third try — no looking. You will not be perfect. Keep going.
 3. **Add someone else.** 2–3 sentences about another person's routine using *il/elle se...*
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Vocabulary to Know Before Week 5

See the full list in your Week 4 Vocabulary Reference. The most important items for Session 9 are:

- *Je me lève / je me couche / je me prépare / je me douche / je m'appelle* — in first person without notes
 - *Il/elle se lève / se couche / se prépare* — third person
 - *À quelle heure?* and *Il est... heures* — telling time at the hour level
 - Sequencing words (*d'abord, ensuite, puis, enfin*) — from Week 3, now with reflexive verbs mixed in
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Crescere — French A1 Week 4 | Questions? Contact your instructor.